transfixed. The photographic images of that horrific day in my memory, the burning smell of metal and flesh in the air and incessant rains of that July evening came rushing back to me. As the train moved out of the station, swerving across the country's oldest rail bridge over the Thane creek, and caught pace, I felt a sense of pride and patriotism on how this one rail coach had been a slap in the face of terrorism. It had lived on, defeating the purpose of terrorism. I travelled in it for the next two rides, Up and Down, filled with emotion, nostalgia and honour. 864-A lives on and so does the country's resilience. My salute to the Indian Railways!

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864-A, the damaged coach of the twelve–car 5.57-p.m. Churchgate-Virar local that was torn apart at Matunga Road station had been made by Jessop & Company, Kolkata and all the material required for restoration, including the frames of the outer shell and the rods supporting it, had been bought from the original company.

In most of the coaches subjected to the attack, the roof had been severely damaged. The main frame of the coach, the backbone of the structure, had sagged and needed replacement. The damaged roof structure had been replaced with metal sheets from original spares. After restoring the main frame, accessories like seats, fans and other such items had been installed. Finally, bogie frames with wheels were attached. After all this was done, various checks like oscillation tests and trial runs under various conditions had been conducted; there were empty runs as well as trials, with loads varying from 20–30 tons, making it fit for a second innings. In 2006, after it was restored, along with four other coaches, it underwent extensive tests before it was declared fit to run. A run of these carriages was also simulated in the workshop under the most difficult conditions and only when the authorities cleared all the set parameters were these coaches put back into service.

After restoration of the coach, it had been transferred to Central Railway as part of an exchange programme while upgrading Mumbai Railway's electric network from the old DC to alternating current (AC). 864–A and a few other older DC coaches were part of this exchange.

The coach was retired in September 2018. And the Central Railway promised to preserve this one's dignity at a rail museum, so that its story